

LINKS GOLF MAJOR

July 16–19, 2026 · Southport, England · \$1,000 Bankroll (\$600 deployed · \$400 reserved for props)

156 players

FIELD · 4 ROUNDS

Royal Birkdale

FIRST OPEN HERE SINCE 2017

Scheffler

DEFENDING CHAMPION

Thu 16th

FIRST TEE



HOW THIS CARD WORKS — TWO-PHASE BUILD

Golf majors settle over four days against a 156-man field — even the favorite is only ~15% to win, so an outright card is a **basket of longshots by nature**. Phase 1 (now): \$600 across six outrights, odds locked at build. Phase 2 (Wednesday, before the first tee): **\$400 reserved** for finishing-position markets — top-10s, head-to-head matchups, make-cut props — which books post closer to Thursday. Those are where the "middle/safe" money lives in golf.

OUTRIGHT BOARD (DK / CONSENSUS AT BUILD)

Scottie Scheffler (def. champ)

+450

Rory McIlroy

+750

Jon Rahm

+1600

Tommy Fleetwood (Southport)

+1600

Xander Schauffele ('24 champ)

+1600

Matt Fitzpatrick

+2000

Cameron Young

+2500

Collin Morikawa ('21 champ)

+2800

Viktor Hovland

+3000

Brooks Koepka

+5000

THE ANGLES

SCHEFFLER +450 · THE ANCHOR

WORLD NO. 1 · DEFENDING OPEN CHAMPION

- ▶ Best player alive, though winless in 13 starts — the price got longer than his true chance
- ▶ Opened +400, drifted to +450; markets over-punish "droughts" for elite iron players
- ▶ Links golf rewards flushed irons + flighted wedges — his exact profile

Est. win: 18% vs ~15% market — the rare positive-EV favorite

FLEETWOOD +1600 · THE HOMETOWN STORY WITH TEETH

BORN IN SOUTHPORT — BIRKDALE IS LITERALLY HIS HOME COURSE

- ▶ Grew up playing Royal Birkdale; no player knows these dunes better
- ▶ Elite links pedigree: multiple top-fives in Opens, best ball-striking season of his career
- ▶ The narrative price and the golf price agree for once

Est. win: 7% vs 5.9% market

THE ENGLISH CONTINGENT

FITZPATRICK +2000 · HOME MAJOR MOTIVATION

- ▶ Fitzpatrick: three wins this season, best year of his career, home country major
- ▶ Knock: 94th in strokes-gained putting — links greens neutralize that gap
- ▶ Rahm +1600: two-time major champ, near-misses at both 2026 majors, built for wind

Rahm est. 7% · Fitzpatrick est. 5.5% — both above market

MORIKAWA + THE LONGSHOT

PROVEN OPEN WINNERS AT LONG PRICES

- ▶ Morikawa +2800: 2021 Open champion, just shot a Sunday 61 at Travelers
- ▶ Koepka +5000: five majors, big-game hunter, priced at career-long odds
- ▶ Majors are where Koepka's focus shows up — 50/1 is a stats-vs-narrative bet

Morikawa est. 4.5% · Koepka est. 2.5% — the 🏆 longshot lives here

\$1,000 BANKROLL ALLOCATION

TOTAL BUDGET

\$1,000

\$600 deployed on 6 outrights · \$400 reserved for Wednesday props

BASKET COVERAGE

~44%

chance one of our six lifts the Claret Jug

★ PHASE 1 · OUTRIGHT WINNER BASKET (MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE — MAX ONE CASHES)

PICK	ODDS	STAKE	EST. WIN	TO WIN	TYPE
1 · Scottie Scheffler Defending champ · drought discount on the best player alive	+450	\$200	18% mkt 15%	+\$900.00	ANCHOR
2 · Jon Rahm Two majors · near-misses all season · wind player	+1600	\$100	7% mkt 5.9%	+\$1,600.00	VALUE
3 · Tommy Fleetwood Southport native — Birkdale is his home course	+1600	\$100	7% mkt 5.9%	+\$1,600.00	HOME TURF
4 · Matt Fitzpatrick 3 wins this season · English home major	+2000	\$80	5.5% mkt 4.8%	+\$1,600.00	VALUE
5 · Collin Morikawa 2021 Open champ · Sunday 61 at Travelers	+2800	\$70	4.5% mkt 3.4%	+\$1,960.00	VALUE
6 · 🏆 Brooks Koepka The longshot — 5 majors, career-long price, big-game DNA	+5000	\$50	2.5% mkt 2%	+\$2,500.00	LONGSHOT

PHASE 2 · WEDNESDAY (BEFORE FIRST TEE)

7 · RESERVED — Finishing-position props Top-10s, 72-hole head-to-heads, make-cut props — lines post midweek	TBD	\$400	—	TBD	PENDING
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Portfolio note. The six outrights are mutually exclusive — at most one cashes, but any one of them pays for the entire card several times over (Scheffler +\$900 minimum, Koepka +\$2,500 maximum). Combined coverage: ~44% that one of ours wins the Jug. The reserved \$400 converts into higher-probability props Wednesday so the card isn't pure lottery. **McIlroy +750 is our biggest deliberate fade** — playing too infrequently this year to trust at half Fleetwood's price.

ALLOCATION SUMMARY

\$600

DEPLOYED (OF \$1,000)

6 + props

BETS

~44%

BASKET COVERAGE

+\$2,500

BEST SINGLE PAYOUT

Fictitious \$1,000 bankroll test — no real money wagered. For entertainment purposes only.

Odds: DraftKings / consensus boards + Golf Digest reporting, locked at build (Sun Jul 12). Phase 2 props added Wednesday Jul 15. Settlement Sunday Jul 19 · tracked in [betting_tracker.xlsx](#), tab "The Open".